

1. Fixed Window Limiter (`FixedWindowLimiter`)

- **The Approach:** Divides time into static, non-overlapping windows. It maps incoming requests to a discrete time slot and increments an atomic request counter. When the window boundary is crossed, the counter resets. [1, 2]
 - **Time Complexity:**
 - **Best/Average Case:** $\mathcal{O}(1)$ — Under low contention, a single Compare-And-Set (CAS) loop iteration successfully increments the counter.
 - **Worst Case:** $\mathcal{O}(\text{threads})$ — Under heavy thread contention, threads will spin in the `while(true)` loop failing the CAS operation until they successfully update the state.
 - **Space Complexity:** $\mathcal{O}(1)$ (**Constant Space**)
 - The memory footprint is strictly fixed. The `WindowState` record only holds two primitive values (`long start` and `int count`), requiring less than **32 bytes** of heap allocation per client, regardless of the maximum request volume or window size. [1, 2]
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2. Sliding Window Limiter (`SlidingWindowLimiter`)

- **The Approach:** Tracks a rolling window log by storing a timestamp for every individual successful request. It dynamically filters out old timestamps older than `now - winNs` upon every request entry.
 - **Time Complexity:**
 - **Best/Average Case:** $\mathcal{O}(N)$ — Where N is the number of active requests currently stored in the window (bounded by `maxReq`). For every incoming request, the code executes a linear loop to filter out expired timestamps and a second loop to build the replacement array.
 - **Worst Case:** $\mathcal{O}(N \times \text{threads})$ — Under extreme thread contention, multiple threads pass the limit check, copy the array, and race to CAS. The losing threads discard their copied array, loop back, and re-scan the timestamp array from scratch. [1, 2]
 - **Space Complexity:** $\mathcal{O}(N)$ (**Linear Space**)
 - Where N is the number of active requests (at most `maxReq`). The immutable `SlidingState` stores an array containing exactly the timestamps of unexpired requests. Memory usage scales directly with your maximum request capacity threshold.
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3. Token Bucket Limiter (TokenBucketLimiter)

- **The Approach:** Utilizes a lazy-refill accumulator model. Instead of maintaining a background daemon thread to add tokens, it calculates fractional token generation dynamically whenever a request hits the system using fixed-point integer scaling.
- **Time Complexity:**
 - **Best/Average Case:** $\mathcal{O}(1)$ – Performs simple mathematical primitive operations (multiplication and division) and applies them via a standard single-step atomic reference swap.
 - **Worst Case:** $\mathcal{O}(\text{threads})$ – Under high concurrent request volumes, losing threads spin in the loop. However, your **clock forward-alignment optimization** (`Math.max(now, current.lastRefillTime)`) keeps these retries incredibly lightweight by bypassing expensive system clock hardware queries if another thread has already updated the base timeline. [1]
- **Space Complexity:** $\mathcal{O}(1)$ (Constant Space)
 - The memory structure remains fixed forever. The `BucketState` record stores exactly three primitive elements (`long tokensScaled`, `long lastRefillTime`, and `long remainderNs`), keeping heap allocations bounded to minimal bytes per client. [1, 2]

Complexity Comparison Matrix

Rate Limiter Variant [1, 2, 3, 4]	Time Complexity (No Contention)	Time Complexity (High Contention)	Space Complexity	GC Allocation Profile
Fixed Window	$\mathcal{O}(1)$	$\mathcal{O}(\text{threads})$	$\mathcal{O}(1)$	Zero Churn (Reuses/Creates small records only on success)
Sliding Window	$\mathcal{O}(N)$	$\mathcal{O}(N \times \text{threads})$	$\mathcal{O}(N)$	High Churn (Allocates new <code>long[]</code> arrays on every single loop retry)

Token	$\mathcal{O}(1)$	$\mathcal{O}(\text{threads})$	$\mathcal{O}(1)$	Zero Churn
Bucket				(Reuses/Creates small records only on success)

**Note: N represents the maximum number of requests allowed within the window ($maxReq$).*